black Americans it SEEMS to be: and they dream of seeing it RAZED so that, like the East Berliners, they can ESCAPE to the Promised Land of freedom and opportunity."[18]

Such rhetoric boomeranged back and forth across the Atlantic, pushing politicians to grapple with this walled parallel. In February 1962, as noted, Attorney General Robert F. Kennedy addressed an audience in West Berlin to represent Cold War Berlin and the United States as a part of a "New Frontier" of democratic progress. Kennedy qualified this remark by stating, "For a hundred years, despite our protestations of equality, we had, as you know, a wall of our own—a wall of segregation erected against Negroes. That wall is coming down."[19] Along these lines, other politicians, several of them white, spoke out publicly in America about "Berlin Walls" of segregation. Illinois governor Otto Kerner told the NAACP's 1963 annual meeting that whites and blacks should tear down the "Berlin Wall of prejudice and fear … [and that the] walled-in bitterness we are now creating can destroy us." United Nations ambassador Adlai Stevenson spoke out that same year by saying it does "little good to demand the tearing down of the Wall in Berlin unless we tear down the wall that separates us in our own land." In 1964 Mary Tinglof, a member of the Los Angeles Board of Education, spoke of school inequities "as rigid as Berlin walls."[20] In the first years after the Wall was erected, Americans began using "Berlin Wall" as a portable, descriptive phrase to refer to specific cases of U.S. segregation, imploring officials to tear down physical color-line barriers in cities and towns.[21]

Other forms of American engagement domesticated this rhetorical map of the Wall at sites of homegrown democratic crisis. For example, in newspaper reports of protests and speeches, individuals in dozens of cities demonstrated how the "Berlin Wall" could be used to describe the boundaries in their own communities and did so for years following the Berlin Crisis. The "Berlin Wall" of Atlanta referred to the steel-and-wood barricades erected by the city on Peyton and Harlan Roads in the West End to discourage black development into a mainly white residential area. In 1962 and 1963, protestors carried signs on-site calling it "Atlanta's Wall," while others proclaimed, "We Want No Warsaw Ghetto—Open Peyton Road."[22] This incorporative form of protest sought to bring U.S. racial segregation, Holocaust trauma, and Cold War division into a shared frame. Speaking in 1963 in southeast Michigan, Rev. Dr. James Laird said of the actual Berlin